# Marco Lo Faso

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USC Dornsife
Dana and David Dornsife
College of Letters, Arts and Sciences
*Department of Economics*

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Placement Director: Vittorio Bassi, vbassi@usc.edu
Placement Director: Michael Droste, droste@usc.edu
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**Education**

**University of Southern California**
Ph.D. Economics (expected) 2027
**Harvard University**
Visiting Ph.D. Student, Department of Economics 2025–2026
**Bocconi University**
M.Sc. Public Policy and Political Economy 2019
B.Sc. Economics 2016

**Fields**

Political Economy, Spatial Economics, Applied Microeconomics

**References**

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Thomas Chaney (Chair) | Augustin Bergeron | Jeff Weaver |
| USC Economics | Harvard Economics | USC Economics |
| thomas.chaney@usc.edu | abergeron@fas.harvard.edu | jbweaver@usc.edu |

**Job Market Paper**

**The Geography of Protests: Spatial Fragmentation, Exposure, and Participation in the George Floyd Movement**


Whether protest movements win votes for their cause or cost them votes is unsettled. This paper studies the question by treating protests as spatial events. I ask whether residents of neighborhoods near protest sites, who are exposed to a protest, vote differently from residents of the neighborhoods where participants come from. Combining 7,920 geocoded George Floyd protest events with mobile phone location data, I measure protest participation from each block group. I then exploit differences in exposure and participation within the same zip code to estimate the effect of each on the change in vote shares between 2016 and 2020. Neighborhoods near protest sites saw increases in Republican vote share, a backlash that decays with distance and is larger near violent protests. Neighborhoods whose residents attended protests saw increased Democratic vote share. The effects coexist: the backlash is large but concentrated in the neighborhoods near protest sites, the mobilization small but spread across many neighborhoods. Participation moved about 137,000 votes toward the Democrats, while exposure near protest sites cost them about 87,000; adding the imprecise effect of exposure farther away, the net is not distinguishable from zero. On these estimates, violence cost the movement about half of the local gains it would otherwise have made. The protests' direct local effects are unlikely to have decided the 2020 election.

**Work in Progress**

Congregations and the Market for Urban Floor Space: Evidence from São Paulo
The Urban Constraints on Political Mobilization: Evidence from American Cities
The Labor Market Returns to Religious Networks: Evidence from Uganda (with Aruj Shukla)

**Awards**

Dean's Dissertation Completion Fellowship, USC — $21,218 2026–2027
Lusk Center for Real Estate Research Award, USC — $13,500 2026
Lusk Center for Real Estate Research Award, USC — $15,000 2025
Dan James Fellowship, USC — $40,000 2024–2025
Summer Research Award (x4), USC — $4,000 each 2023–2026

**Employment**

European Central Bank, Frankfurt, Research Intern 2019
European Commission, Brussels, Economic Analyst 2017–2018

**Research Positions**

Research Assistant to Augustin Bergeron, USC 2023
Research Assistant to Ruben Durante, Pompeu Fabra University 2020–2021
Research Assistant to Vincenzo Galasso, Bocconi University 2019–2020

**Teaching**

Teaching Assistant, University of Southern California Fall 2022–Spring 2024
*Introduction to Econometrics* (ECON 318), undergraduate
*Political Economy and Economic Development* (ECON 436), undergraduate
*Intermediate Macroeconomics* (ECON 305), undergraduate
*Macroeconomic Analysis and Policy* (ECON 501), master
Teaching Assistant, Bocconi University 2019–2020
*Welfare and Politics*, master
*Economics of European Integration*, master
*Political Economics*, undergraduate
*European Economic Policy*, undergraduate

**Presentations**

2026: USC Development Seminar, Harvard Graduate Student Workshop in Political Economy
2023–2026: USC Applied Micro Reading Group

**Summer Schools**

Summer School in the Economics of Migration, UC Davis 2024
ACES Summer School in Political Economy, UC Berkeley 2023

**Academic Service**

Co-organizer, Southern California Graduate Conference in Applied Economics
University of Southern California 2023

**Research Grants**

Weiss Fund Research Grant — $5,000 2023–2024

**Software Skills**

Python, R, Stata, MATLAB

**Languages**

Italian (native), English (fluent)

**Citizenship**

Italian (US F-1 visa)